

BEAUFORT WIND SCALE

Beaufort number	Descriptive Terms	Mean wind speed in knots	Sea criterion	Probable mean wave height in metres
 Force 0	Calm	< 1	Sea like a mirror	-
 Force 1	Light air	1 - 3	Ripples with the appearance of scales are formed but without foam crests	0.1
 Force 2	Light breeze	4 - 6	Small wavelets, still short but more pronounced, crests have a glassy appearance and do not break	0.2 (0.3)
 Force 3	Gentle breeze	7 - 10	Large wavelets. Crests begin to break. Foam of glassy appearance. Perhaps scattered white horses	0.6 (1)
 Force 4	Moderate breeze	11 - 16	Small waves becoming longer; fairly frequent white horses	1 (1.5)
 Force 5	Fresh breeze	17 - 21	Moderate waves taking a more pronounced long form; many white horses are formed	2 (2.5)
 Force 6	Strong breeze	22 - 27	Large waves begin to form; the white foam crests are more extensive everywhere	3 (4)
 Force 7	Near gale	28 - 33	Sea heaps up and white foam from breaking waves begins to be blown in streaks along the direction of the wind	4 (5.5)
 Force 8	Gale	34 - 40	Moderately high waves of greater length; edges of crests begin to break into spindrift. The foam is blown in well-marked streaks along the direction of the wind	5.5 (7.5)

	Strong gale	41 - 47	High waves. Dense streaks of foam along the direction of the wind. Crests of waves begin to topple, tumble and roll over. Spray may affect visibility	7 (10)
	Storm	48 - 55	Very high waves with long overhanging crests. The resulting foam in great patches is blown in dense white streaks along the direction of the wind. On the whole the surface of the sea takes a white appearance. The tumbling of the sea becomes heavy and shock-like. Visibility affected.	9 (12.5)
	Violent storm	56 - 63	Exceptionally high waves. The sea is completely covered with long white patches of foam lying along the direction of the wind. Everywhere the edges of the wave crests are blown into froth. Visibility affected.	11.5 (16)
	Hurricane	64 and over	The air is filled with foam and spray. Sea completely white with driving spray; visibility very seriously affected.	14 (-)